

PORCELAIN in translation

One porcelain tradition.
Three worlds.

How does one material acquire different meanings?

Qing China & global cultural exchange

Reinventing tradition



Langyao-red Guanyin vase

Kangxi reign, 1662–1722

Jingdezhen revived
Ming copper-red glazing.

An inherited technique became
a statement of Qing identity.

TRADITION → IMPERIAL IDENTITY

Translating technology

Swallows & flowering branches



Imperial falangcai “swallows” bowl

Sotheby’s / Dr Alice Cheng bowl

Qianlong reign, 1736–1795

European enamel knowledge
+ Chinese porcelain and painting

Selected and adapted in imperial court workshops.

FOREIGN KNOWLEDGE → COURT TASTE

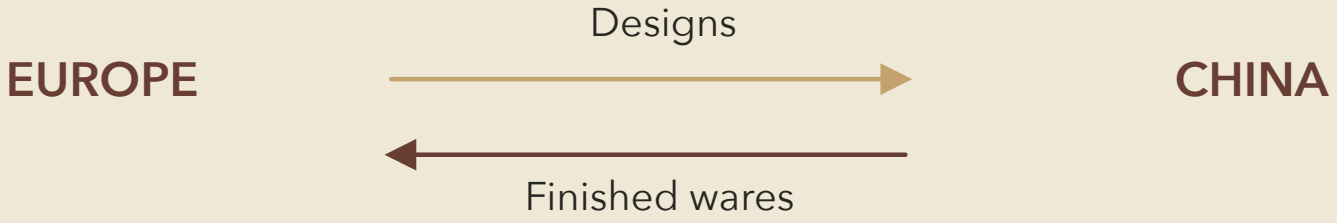
Responding to the market



China, eighteenth century

Chinese armorial export plate

Chinese artisans translated European heraldry into porcelain.



TRADE → STATUS AND IDENTITY

One tradition. Three worlds.

Patrons, institutions, production and use shaped meaning.

CHINESE PAST

Reinventing tradition

Imperial identity

Jingdezhen

QING COURT

Translating technology

Imperial taste

Beijing

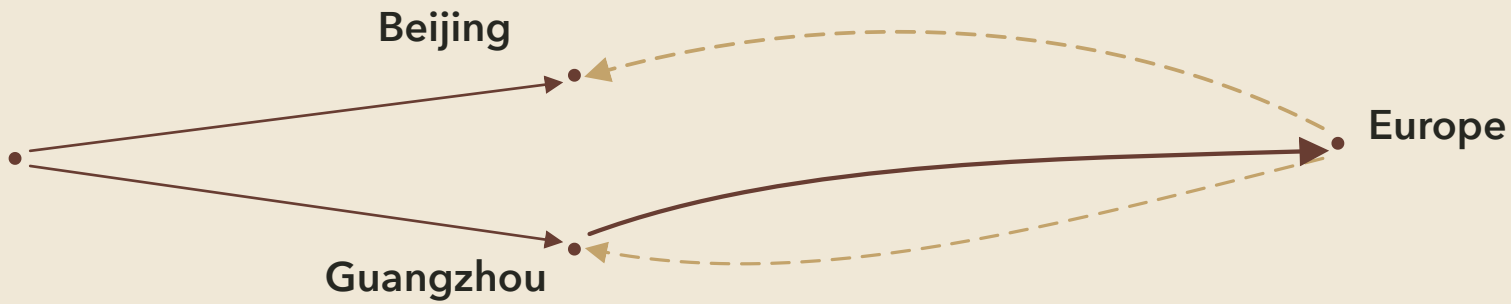
Guangzhou

EUROPEAN MARKETS

Responding to the market

Status & identity

Europe



Conceptual flows / schematic routes

Qing China actively shaped global exchange.